

- 4 . . . inhabitants of the Hittite country, in the
month of Airu, of the third year of
5 [Nebuchadnezzar king of] Babylon opposed his
troops.
6 [Nebuchadnezzar] summoned his troops, in 13 days
to
7 [the Hittite country] he marched. Of the people
inhabiting Ammanu (Anti-Lebanon)
8 their heads he beat off
9 [upon poles] he hung
10 [. . . to . . .] he brought . . .

(4) . . . nišê (mât) Ḫat-tum ina arḫi airu šattu III-kan (5) . . .
tin-tir(ki) pa-ni sâbê-šu is-ba-tu (6) [. . . id-ki-e-ma ina XIII(ta)
û-mu a-na (7) [. . . ki]-i ik-šu-da ša nišê a-ši-bi (alu) Am-ma-na-
nu (8) [. . .] šu-nu kaḫḫadi-šu-nu u-be-ni-ma (9) [. . .]-di i-lu-
ul-ma (10) [. . .] u-ša-aš-bit

6. BEROSSOS ON THE NEO-BABYLONIAN PERIOD ¹

A little lower down Berossos adds what follows in his history of antiquity; I shall set down the words of Berossos, which are as follows: When Nabopolassar, his father [i. e., of Nebuchadnezzar], had heard that the satrap whom he had set over Egypt, and over the regions of Coele-Syria and Phoenicia, had revolted from him, being unable himself to endure the fatigue, committed certain parts of his forces to his son Nebuchadnezzar, who was still a young man, and sent him against the rebel.

¹ Josephus, *Contra Apion*, i, § 19, 134-138; *Flavii Josephi Opera*, edited by B. Niese (Berlin, 1889), Vol. v, pp. 24-26. Compare Des Flavius Josephus *Schrift gegen Apion*, Text und Erklärung aus dem Nachlass von J. G. Müller, herausgegeben durch C. J. Riggenbach u. C. von Orelli (Basel, 1877). Compare translation in Josephus, *Whiston's translation*, edited by A. R. Shilleto. London, 1890. Vol. v, pp. 192, 193.

[Εἰθ' ἐξῆς ὑποκαταβάς ὀλίγον ὁ Βηρώσος πάλιν παρατίθεται ἐν τῇ τῆς ἀρχαίου ἱστοριογραφίᾳ. αὐτὰ δὲ παραθήσομαι τὰ τοῦ Βηρώσου τοῦτον ἔχοντα τὸν τρόπον „ἀκούσας δ' ὁ πατὴρ αὐτοῦ Ναβopolάσσαρος, ὅτι ὁ τεταγμένος σατράπης ἐν τε Αἰγύπτῳ καὶ τοῖς περὶ τὴν Συρίαν τὴν κοίλῃν καὶ τὴν Φοινίκην τόποις ἀποστάτης γέγονεν, οὐ δυνάμενος αὐτὸς ἐτι κακοπαθεῖν συστήσας τῷ υἱῷ Ναβοκοδρόσορῳ ὄντι ἐτι ἐν ἡλικίᾳ μέρη τινὰ τῆς δυνάμεως ἐξέπεμψεν ἐπ' αὐτόν· συμμαχίας δὲ Ναβουκοδρόσορος τῷ ἀποστάτῃ καὶ παραταξάμενος αὐτοῦ

Nebuchadrezzar joined battle with him, conquered him, and reduced the land at once to his dominion. It so happened at this time that his father fell ill in the city of Babylon and died, having reigned twenty-one years. When Nebuchadrezzar heard, not long afterward, of his father's end, he set in order the affairs of Egypt and the rest of the district, and committed the captives which he had taken from the Jews, Phœnicians, and Syrians, and from the nations belonging to Egypt, to some of his friends, that they might conduct the heavy-armed troops and the baggage to Babylonia, while he himself pushed over the desert with but a few to Babylon. When he arrived there he found that public affairs had been managed by the Chaldeans and the kingdom preserved by the principal persons among them, so that he was now ruler of all his father's dominions, and ordered the captives, when they arrived, to be assigned dwelling places in the most convenient parts of Babylonia.

τ' ἐκράτει καὶ τὴν χώραν ἐξ ἀρχῆς ὑπὸ τὴν αὐτῶν βασιλείαν ἐποιήσατο· τῷ τε πατρὶ αὐτοῦ συνέβη Ναβοπολασάρῳ κατὰ τοῦτον τον καιρὸν ἀρρωστήσαντι ἐν τῇ Βαβυλωνίῳ πόλει μεταλλάξαι τον βίον ἐτη βεβασιλευκότι· κά' αἰσθόμενος δὲ μετ' οὐ πολὺ τὴν τοῦ πατρὸς τελευτὴν Ναβουκοδρόσορος, καταστήσας τὰ κατὰ τὴν Αἴγυπτον πράγματα καὶ τὴν λοιπὴν χώραν, καὶ τοὺς αἰχμαλώτους Ἰουδαίων τε καὶ Φοινίκων καὶ Σύρων καὶ τῶν κατὰ τὴν Αἴγυπτον ἐθνῶν συντάξας τισὶ τῶν φίλων μετὰ τῆς βαρυντάτης δυνάμεως καὶ τῆς λοιπῆς ὠφελείας ἀνακομίζειν εἰς τὴν Βαβυλωνίαν, αὐτὸς ὁρμῆας ὀλιγοστὸς παρεγένετο διὰ τῆς ἐρήμου εἰς Βαβυλῶνα· καταλαβὼν δὲ τὰ πράγματα διοικούμενα ὑπὸ Χαλδαίων καὶ διατηρουμένην τὴν βασιλείαν ὑπὸ τοῦ βελτίστου αὐτῶν, κυριεύσας ὁλοκλήρου τῆς πατρικῆς ἀρχῆς τοῖς μὲν αἰχμαλώτοις παραγενομένοις συνέταξεν [αὐτοῖς] κατοικίας ἐν τοῖς ἐπιτηδαιοτάτοις τῆς Βαβυλωνίας τόποις ἀποδεῖξαι.

XI. NABONIDUS, BELSHAZZAR, AND CYRUS

Immediately upon the death of Nebuchadrezzar his son, Amel-Marduk,¹ the Evil-Merodach of the biblical

¹ Man (servant) of Marduk.

writers,¹ ascended the throne and assumed the impossible burden of sustaining the vast empire which a great political and military genius had built up. The one event of his reign which has survived in the memory of man is preserved by the Hebrews alone.² He set Jehoiachin free—an act which indicates a policy directly opposed to that of his father. With this accords perfectly the reference of Berossos, who says that he ruled unlawfully and tyrannically.³ He was assassinated and his brother-in-law, Nergal-shar-usur (i. e., “Nergal protect the king,” Gr., *Neriglissor*), became king. He seems to have endeavored to follow closely the example of Nebuchadrezzar, whose daughter was his queen, and his inscriptions even imitate the phraseology of his great exemplar. He devoted himself largely to building and to restoration. Of the outer and larger politics of his reign we have only the hint that the relations of Babylon to Media were strained, and that the Medes pressed into the northern part of the valley and took Harran.

In 556 Nergal-shar-usur died, and his son, Labashi-Marduk, while still a youth, came to the throne. He was assassinated after but nine months of a precarious tenure of the throne, tradition alleging that he had displayed evil traits of character.⁴ We may perhaps discern in this simply an excuse to justify his violent removal as a part of a priestly plot to win the throne. The supposition finds a justification in the appearance as king, not of a Chaldean, but of a man of Babylonian origin, Nabonidus, whose whole reign is a continuous manifestation of interest in all things priestly and religious.

¹ 2 Kings 25. 27–30.

² See passage just cited.

³ ἀνόμως και ἀσελγώς. Berossos, in Eusebi Chronicorum Liber Prior, ed. Alfred Schoene, col. 50.

⁴ Says Berossus, διὰ τὸ πολλὰ ἐκφαίνειν κακότητα.

Nabonidus (Babylonian, *Nabu-na'idu*, i. e., "Nabu is glorious") was the son of Nabu-balatsu-iqbi, and must have occupied a distinguished position in the kingdom before he ascended the throne. Like Nebuchadrezzar, he was a great builder, but unlike him by far the greater portion of his labors was given to the reërection of temples. Nebuchadrezzar had constructed palaces, laid out great streets, erected immense walls of defense. It was the glory of Nabonidus to see that gods dwelt more magnificently than men, and that ancient shrines fallen into ruin should arise in a grandeur far exceeding the glory of earlier days. Other kings had been content when rebuilding fallen walls of temples to clear away the rubbish to the ground, leveling off a surface higher than it had been and then building upon it. Nabonidus was not content with work of that character. He must dig down until the earliest foundation stones were discovered. If the temple had been several times rebuilt it interested him to have the records of the several kings who had worked upon it recovered. To this religious, and, if one might so say, archæological, passion we owe much of our knowledge of early Babylonian history, for he had all these records read to him as they were found, and his own inscriptions carefully preserve the accounts of those who had built before him. No longer are building inscriptions dreary wastes of boastful words recording the erection of walls "mountain high," they are now decorated with the names of mighty kings of the distant past, whose honor Nabonidus was proud to record, as he linked his own name with theirs.

To us the archæological researches of the king are not merely interesting; they afford us in some instances our only means of restoring kings of bygone days to

their proper place in history. But devotion to the gods and a passion for archæological learning seem to have worked ill for kingcraft. He was not building walls of defense, as had Nebuchadrezzar; he was not making an army, as had Nabopolassar. The slow growth of a mighty new power beyond his eastern borders made no impression on his absorbed mind. He had no political insight and could not see that the new power would soon be strong enough to covet his dominions and to take them. When Cyrus had driven the Medes out of Harran, Nabonidus glories in the "young servant of Marduk,"¹ as he calls him, but does not see that this young servant of Marduk would soon be driven by his own destiny and growing ambition to become his enemy and successor. On the contrary, Nabonidus brings an army to rebuild the temple in Harran, and lays his whole empire under tribute to pay the cost while he glories in the deeds of those whose royal hands had laid its early foundations.

Nabonidus lived in Tema, a place whose insignificance had given it no other mention in the annals of his country. There we can imagine him absorbed in great plans for temple building and restoration and engrossed in the work of his historiographers, who brought him their calculations of the dates when other kings had lived.

The affairs of state, the command of the army, the administration of public affairs had all fallen into the hands of the king's son, Belshazzar (Babylonian, *Bel-shar-usur*, "Bel protect the king"), who ruled in his father's name and enjoyed his confidence and affection.

Nabonidus seems to have neglected Babylon in very

¹ arad-su sa-ab-ri. Nabonidus, Abû-Habba, cylinder i, 29. Compare *Keilinschriftliche Bibliothek*, iii, 2, p. 98.

large measure. He calls himself, indeed, by the official title borne by former kings, "Preserver of Esagila and Ezida," but his concerns were evidently elsewhere. In the ancient city of Sippar he razed to the foundations the remains of the temple of the Sun (Shamash), which had been restored but forty-five years before by Nebuchadrezzar. There he found the very lowest foundation stone, on which his savants read the name of Naram-Sin, who lived, as their records showed, thirty-two hundred years before.¹ Upon that exact spot the new foundations were laid and above them rose a new temple far more splendid than the former. For its roof no less than five thousand cedar beams were brought from the far-distant northland, while yet others were required for its massive doors.

At about the same time he reconstructed the temple of E-ulbar, the shrine of the goddess Ishtar-Anunit. There he did not find the earliest foundation, but contented himself with one laid only eight hundred years before his time.

While all these works were in progress another people, fresh and vigorous, untainted by the decay which civilization has often brought, were preparing to undo this splendor and possess the wealth and power which Nabonidus had inherited or amassed.

The beginnings of new powers in the world's history are usually obscure, and to this rule the rise of the great people who were to engulf Babylonia is no exception. But certain lines in the great movement are sufficiently clear to be traced with some certainty. The fall of Nineveh was brought about by the alliance between the Medes and the Babylonians, but it was

¹ V R., 62, b, 57-60. Compare *Keilinschriftl. Bibl.*, iii, 2, p. 105; compare Rogers *History of Babylonia and Assyria*, i, p. 318f.

the former who struck the fatal blow. The leader of this new Median state was Cyaxares (Uvakhshatara), whose reign lasted until 585 B. C. It was he who really made the name of Medes a terror over all western Asia. It is difficult to follow his course, for the people whom he led were men of action, not writers of tablets, like the Babylonians. We can, however, see them possessing all Assyria after Nineveh was laid waste, and with it the whole of the great northern valley between the Tigris and Euphrates, including those Babylonian cities which had acknowledged the Assyrian overlordship. By 560 their dominion was acknowledged as far west as the Halys, which separated them from the kingdom of Lydia, over which Croesus, of proverbial memory, was now king (560-546 B. C.).

While these conquests were proceeding, and the world seemed ready to bow down at the feet of the overpowering Medes, there had been born in Anshan, as the son of Cambyses, the boy Cyrus, who grew to manhood as king of Anshan, and as a tributary prince beneath the authority of Astyages, king of the Medes. It was impossible that a man such as he should long remain beneath the sway of another. In 553 he arose against Astyages, and, according to the story which Nabonidus has preserved for us, Astyages was delivered bound into his hands by his own treacherous troops. In 550 Cyrus took Ecbatana and sacked it, and brought there to an end the Median power. The Persians under Cyrus now fell heir to all that the Medes had won, and in 549 turned against Croesus, who was taken in 546. The Lydian empire was now also brought under Persian control, and before the end of 545 the entire peninsula of Asia Minor was a part of the new Persian empire, divided into satrapies and governed with a strong hand. Even

the isles of the sea began to give submission to the power that had in a night strode out of the unknown wilds of Asia and broken rudely upon the dreams of the Greeks, not only in the islands, but even in the peninsula itself.

Cyrus had now prepared the way for the absorption of Babylonia, with its valuable possessions in Syro-Phoenicia along the Mediterranean coast. While these far-reaching conquests were awaking alarm, even in distant Greece, Nabonidus was paying no heed, busily absorbed as ever in the building and restoring and exploring for ancient foundation stones. The record of his fatuous course is written in the sententious phrases of the Babylonian Chronicle, which record his residence in Tema. In 549, when the Lydian king was full of preparations for the struggle which he knew to be inevitable, Nabonidus was in Tema. In 547 he was still in Tema, and did not even enter Babylon to pay reverence at the great shrine of the gods, or to direct the urgent affairs of state. On the fifth day of the month of Nisan the king's mother died at Dur-Karasu, on the Euphrates above Sippar, and for her a great mourning was made. But on that same day Cyrus crossed the Tigris below Arbela and entered Assyria. Belshazzar was in northern Accad with an army, and on him were such hopes of defense as the country may have felt.

The Chronicle is now badly broken, as an examination of the copy¹ will show, and we are not able to follow the events from year to year. When next the narrative is resumed the year 539 has been reached and Nabonidus is busy removing gods from their shrines to Babylon. In that same year Cyrus met Belshazzar at

¹ See Schrader, *Keilinschriftliche Bibliothek*, iii, 2, p. 128f.

the canal of Salsallat, near Opis, and defeated him. On the fourteenth day of Tammuz, Sippar was taken without a blow, and two days later the van of the army of Cyrus entered Babylon as the gates swung open without resistance¹ to receive it. Cyrus was not in command, but had remained behind, while Ugbaru (Goburyas), governor of Gutium, led the advance. Nabonidus was taken prisoner in the city. Cambyses, son of Cyrus, seems to have been called king at first, but Cyrus himself was later called king of Babylon, "king of lands."

¹ Cyrus-Cylinder, line 17 (see below, p. 381).

1. INSCRIPTION FROM THE FOUR CLAY CYLINDERS OF NABONIDUS, KING OF BABYLON¹

COLUMN I:

(1) Nabonidus, king of Babylon, (2) supporter of E-sagila (3), and E-zida (4), who fears the great gods, am I.

(5) E-Lugal-malga-si-di, (6) the step tower of E-gisshir-gal, (7) which is in Ur, (8) which Ur-Engur, a king of former time, (9) had built but finished not; (10) Dungi, his son, (11) did finish his work. (12) (From the inscriptions of Ur-engur (13) and Dungi, his son, I learned (14, 15) that Ur-engur built that step tower, (16) but had not finished it; (17, 18) Dungi, his son, finished the work.) (19) This step tower (20) had now become old, (21) and upon the old foundation, (22) which Ur-Bau and

¹ These cylinders were found at the four corners of the temple of Sin at Ur. Published I R., 68, No. 1. Transliterated and translated by Peiser, *Keilinschriftl. Bibl.*, iii, 2, pp. 94ff.; Langdon, *Neubabylonische Königsinschriften*, No. 5, pp. 250ff.

COLUMN I:

(1) (m, ilu) Nabû-na'id šar Babili(ki) (2) za-ni-in E-sag-ila (3) ù E-zi-da (4) pa-liḫ ilāni rabûti a-na-ku (5) E-lugal-malga-si-di (6) zik-ku-rat E-gis-šir-gal (7) ša ki-rib Ur(ki) (8) ša (m) Ur-(ilu) engur šarru šu-ut maḫ-ri (9) i-pu-šú-ma la u-šak-li-lu-uš (10) (ilu) Dun-gi māri-šu (11) ši-pu-šu ú-šak-lil (12) i-na mu-sa-ri-e ša Ur-(ilu) Engur (13) ù (ilu) Dun-gi māri-šu a-mur-ma (14) ša zik-ku-rat šú-a-ti (15) Ur-(ilu) Engur i-pu-šú-ma (16) la u-šak-li-lu-uš (17) (m, ilu) Dun-gi mari-šu ši-pir-šu (18) u-šak-lil (19) i-na-an-ni zik-ku-rat šú-a-tú (20) la-ba-ri-iš il-lik-ma (21) e-li te-me-en-na la-bi-ri (22) ša (m) Ur (ilu) Engur ù

Dungi, (23) his son, had built, I undertook the reconstruction (24) of this temple tower, (25) as of old, (26, 27) with bitumen and burned brick, (28) and for Sin, the lord of the gods of heaven and earth, (29) the king of the gods, the gods of gods (30) that inhabit the great heavens, the lord of E-gish-shir-gal, which is (31) in Ur, my territories, [Column II] (1) I founded (2) and built it.

(3) O Sin, lord of the gods, (4) king of the gods of heaven and earth, (5) the god of gods, (6) that inhabits the great heavens, (7) when thou dost (8) joyfully enter into that house, may the (9) good done to Esagila, (10) Ezida and E-gisshir-gal (11) the temples of thy great godhead (12) be upon thy lips, (13) and the fear of thy (14) great godhead do thou (15) implant in the heart of its people, let them not sin (16) against thy great godhead, (17) like the heavens let their foundations (18) stand fast.

(19) As for me, Nabonidus, king of Babylon, (20) save me from sinning against (21) thy great godhead. (22) A life of far days as a gift (23) grant unto me.

(24) And as for Belshazzar, (25) the first-born son, (26) the issue of my body, (27) do thou implant in his heart (28) the fear of thy great divinity. (29) Let him not turn (30) unto sinning. (31) Let him be satisfied with fullness of life.

(ilu) Dun-gi (23) mari-šu i-pu-šú (24) ziḫ-ku-rat šu-a-ti (25) ki-ma la-bi-ri-im-ma (26) i-na ku-up-ri ù a-gur-ri (27) ba-ta-ak-šu aš-bat-ma (28) a-na (ilu) Sin bel ilāni ša šami-e u irši-tim (29) šar ilāni ilāni¹ ša ilāni (30) a-ši-ib šamê-e rabûti bel E-giṣ-šir-gal (31) ša ḳi-rib Ur(ki) beli-ia. [Column II] (1) uš-ši-iš-ma (2) e-pu-uš

(3) (ilu) Sin be-lí ilāni (4) šar ilāni ša šamê-e u irši-tim (5) ilāni ša ilāni (6) a-ši-ib šamê-e rabûti (7) a-na bîti šú-a-ti (8) ḥa-di-iš i-na e-ri-bi-ka (9) damḳâti E-sag-ila (10) E-zi-da E-giṣ-šir-gal (11) bîṭâti ilu-ú-ti-ka rabî-ti (12) liš-ša-ki-in šap-tuk-ka (13) ù pu-luḫ-ti ilu-ú-ti-ka (14) rabî-ti lib-bi nišê-šu (15) šú-uš-kin-ma la i-ḥaṭ-tu-ú (16) a-na ilu-ú-ti-ka rabî-ti (17) ki-ma šamê-e iš-da-šú-nu (18) li-ku-nu (19) ia(-a)-ti (ilu) Nabû-na'id šar Bâbili(ki) (20) i-na ḥi-tu ilu-ú-ti-ka (21) rabîti (22) šu-zib-an-ni-ma (23) ba-la-ṭu ù-mu ru-ku-ti (24) a-na ši-riḳ-ti šur-ka-m (25) ù ša (m, ilu) Bel-šar-ušur (26) mâru reš-tu-u (27) ḡi-it lib-bi-ia (28) pu-luḫ-ti ilu-ú-ti-ka rabî-ti (29) lib-bu-uš šú-uš-kin-ma (30) ai ir-ša-a (31) ḥi-ti-ti (32) la-li-e balâti liš-bi

¹ Word repeated by mistake of the scribe.

2. THE CYLINDER OF CYRUS¹

(1) his troops (2) . . . quarters of the world (3) . . . a weakling was established in rule over the land (4) *and* . . . a similar one he appointed over them, (5) like E-saggil he made . . . to Ur and the rest of the cities, (6) a command dishonoring them . . . he planned daily and in enmity, (7) he caused the daily offering to cease; he appointed . . . he established within the city. The worship of Marduk, king of the gods . . . (8) he showed hostility toward his city daily . . . his *people* he brought all of them to ruin through servitude without rest. (9) On account of their complaints the lord of the gods became furiously angry and *left* their land; the gods, who dwelt among them, left their homes, (10) in anger over his bringing into Babylon. Marduk . . . to all the dwelling places, which had become ruins, (11) and the people of Sumer and Akkad, who were like corpses . . . he turned and granted

¹ Published V R., Plate 35 (London, 1880), 2d edition, 1910. Transliterated and translated by Schrader, *Keilinschriftliche Bibliothek*, iii, 2, pp. 120ff. Transcribed and translated after a new collation of the text by O. E. Hagen, *Beiträge zur Assyriologie*, ii, pp. 208ff. (1891). Transliterated and translated anew by Weissbach, *Die Keilinschriften der Achmâneniden* (Vorderasiatische Bibliothek), pp. 2ff.

(1) . . . -ni-šu (2) [. -ki]-ib-ra-tim (3) -ka gal ma-tu-ú iš-šak-na a-na e-nu-tu ma-ti-šu (4) ši-[-. ta-am]-ši-li ú-ša-aš-ki-na ši-ru-šu-un (5) ta-am-ši-li É-sag-ila i-te-[-. -ti]m a-na Uri(ki) ù si-it-ta-tim ma-ḫa-za (6) pa-ra-aš la si-ma-a-ti-šu-nu ta-[-. -l]i ú-mi-ša-am-ma id-di-ni-ib-bu-ub ù ana na-ak-ri-tim (7) sat-tuk-ku ù-šab-ti-li ú-ad-[di iš]-tak-ka-an ki-rib ma-ḫa-zi pa-la-ḫa (ilu) Marduk šar ilâni [šá]-ki-še a-šu-uš-šu (8) li-mu-ut-ti ali-šu [i-te]-ni-ip-pu-uš ú-mi-ša-am-ma na-[-. niše] i-na ab-ša-a-ni la ta-ap-šu-úḫ-tim ú-ḫal-li-ik kul-lat-si-in (9) a-na ta-zi-im-ti-ši-na (ilu) Ellil (lil) ilani iz-zi-iš i-gu-ug-ma ki-su-úr-šu-un ilâni a-ši-ib lib-bi-šu-nu i-zi-bu ad-ma-an-šu-un (10) i-na ug-ga-ti šá ú-še-ri-bi a-na ki-rib Babili (ilu) Marduk ti- li-sa-aḫ-ra a-na nap-ḫar da-ád-mi šá in-na-du-ú šú-bat-su-un (11) ù niše mât Šú-me-ri ù Akkadi(ki) ša i-mu-ú ša-lam-ta-aš ú-sa-aḫ-bi-ir ka- -ši ir-ta-ši ta-a-a-ra kul-lat ma-ta-a-ta ka-li-ši-na i-bi-iḫ ib-ri-e

mercy. In all lands everywhere (12) he searched, he looked through them and sought a righteous prince, after his own heart, whom he took by the hand. Cyrus, king of Anshan, he called by name, to lordship over the whole world he appointed him. (13) The land of Qutu, all the Umman-manda, he cast down at his feet. The black-headed people, whom he gave his hands to conquer, (14) he took them in justice and righteousness. Marduk, the great lord, looked joyously on the caring for his people, on his pious works and his righteous heart. (15) To his city Babylon he caused him to go, he made him take the road to Babylon, going as a friend and companion at his side. (16) His numerous troops, in number unknown, like the waters of a river, marched armed at his side. (17) Without battle and conflict he permitted him to enter Babylon. He spared his city Babylon a calamity. Nabonidus, the king, who did not fear him, he delivered into his hand. (18) All the people of Babylon, of Sumer and Akkad, princes and governors, fell down before him and kissed his feet. They rejoiced in his sovereignty, their faces shone. (19) The lord, who by his power brings the dead to life, who amid *destruction* and *injury* had protected them, they blessed him joyously, honoring his name.

šu (12) iš-te'-e-ma ma-al-ki i-ša-ru bi-bil lib-bi šá it-ta-ma-aḥ ka-tu-uš-šu (m) Ku-ra-aš šar ali An-šá-an it-ta-bi ni-bi-it-su a-na ma-li-ku-tim kul-la-ta nap-ḥar iz-zak-ra šú-[ma-šu] (13) mât Kū-ti-i gi-mir um-man Man-da ú-ka-an-ni-ša a-na še-pi-šu niše šal-mat kaḫkadu(du) ša ú-šá-ak-ši-du ka-ta-a-šu (14) i-na ki-it-tim ú mi-ša-ru iš-te-ni'-e-ši-na-a-tim (ilu) Marduk belu rabu ta-ru-ú niše-šu ip-še-e-ti šá dam-ka-a-ta ù lib-ba-šú i-šá-ra ḥa-di-iš ip-pa-al-li-is (15) a-na ali-šu Bab-ilani(ki) a-la-ak-šú ik-bi ú-ša-aš-bi-it-su-ma ḥar-ra-nu Babili ki-ma ib-ri ù tap-pi-e it-tal-la-ka i-da-a-šu (16) um-ma-ni-šu rap-ša-a-tim šá ki-ma me-e nari la ú-ta-ad-du-ú ni-ḥa-šú-un kakke-šú-nu ga-an-du-ma i-šá-ad-di-ḥa i-da-a-šú (17) ba-lu kab-li ù ta-ḥa-zi ú-še-ri-ba-aš ki-rib Babili ala-šú Bab-ilani(ki) i-ṭi-ir i-na šap-šá-ki (m, ilu) Nabu-na'id šarru la pa-li-ḥi-šú ú-ma-al-la-a ka-tu-uš-šu (18) niše Babili ka-li-šú-nu nap-ḥar mât Šú-me-ri u Akkadī(ki) ru-bi-e ù šak-ka-nak-ka šá-pal-šú ik-mi-sa ú-na-aš-ši-ku še-pu-uš-šu iḥ-du-ú a-na šarru-ú-ti-šu im-mi-ru pa-nu-uš-šu-un (19) be-lu šá i-na tu-kul-ti-šá ú-bal-li-ṭu mi-tu-ta-an i-na bu-ta-ḫu ù pa-ki-e ig-mi-lu

(20) I am Cyrus, king of the world, the great king, the powerful king, king of Babylon, king of Sumer and Akkad, king of the four quarters of the world, (21) son of Cambyases, the great king, king of the city of Anshan, grandson of Cyrus, the great king, king of the city of Anshan; great-grandson of Teïspes, the great king, king of the city of Anshan; (22) eternal seed of royalty whose rule Bel and Nabu love, whose government they rejoice in in their heart. When I made my triumphal entrance into Babylon, (23) with joy and rejoicing I took up my lordly residence in the royal palace, Marduk, the great lord, moved the noble heart of the inhabitants of Babylon to me, while I gave daily care to his worship. (24) My numerous troops marched peacefully into Babylon. In all Sumer and Akkad I permitted no enemy to enter. (25) The needs of Babylon and of all its cities I gladly took heed to. The people of Babylon [and . . .], and the dishonoring yoke was removed from them. Their dwellings, (26) which had fallen, I restored. I cleared out their ruins. Marduk, the great lord, rejoiced in my pious deeds, and (27) graciously blessed me, Cyrus, the king who worships him, and Cambyases, my own son, and all my troops, (28) while we, before him, joyously praised

kul-la-ta-an ʔa-bi-iš ik-ta-ar-ra-bu-šu iš-tam-ma-ru zi-ki-ir-šú (20) a-na-ku (m)Ku-ra-aš šar kiš-šat šarru rabu šarru dan-nu šar Babili šar mât Šú-me-ri ù Ak-ka-di šar kib-ra-a-ti ir-bit-tim (21) mar (m)Ka-am-bu-zi-ia šarru rabu šar alu An-šá-an mar mari (m)Ku-ra-aš šarru rabu šar alu An-šá-an šA.BAL.BAL (m)Ši-iš-pi-iš šarru rabu šar alu An-šá-an (22) ziru da-ru-ú ša šarru-ú-tu ša (ilu) Bel u (ilu) Nabu ir-a-mu pa-la-a-šu a-na ʔu-ub lib-bi-šu-nu iḫ-ši-ḫa šarru-ut-su e-nu-ma a-na ki-rib Babili e-ru-bu sa-li-mi-iš (23) i-na ul-ši ù ri-šá-a-tim i-na ekal ma-al-ki ar-ma-a šú-bat be-lu-tim (ilu) Marduk belu rabu lib-bi ri-it-pa-šu ša mare Babili ù . . . an-ni-ma ú-mi-šam a-še'-a pa-la-aḫ-šu (24) um-ma-ni-ia rap-ša-tim i-na ki-rib Babili i-šá-ad-di-ḫa šú-ul-ma-niš nap-ḫar mat [Šu-me-ri] ù Akkadi(ki) mu-gal-[l]i-tim ul ú-šar-ši (25) dannat Babili ù kul-lat ma-ḫa-zi-šu i-na ša-li-im-tim aš-te'-e mare Babi[li] . . . ki ma-la lib-[-] . . . ma ab-ša-a-ni la si-ma-ti-šu-nu šú-bat-su-un (26) an-ḫu-ut-su-un ú-pa-aš-ši-ḫa ú-šá-ap-ṭi-ir sa-ar-ba-šu-nu a-na ip-še-e-ti-[ia] (ilu) Marduk belu rabu iḫ-di-e-ma (27) a-na ia-a-ti (m)Ku-ra-aš šarru pa-li-iḫ-šu ù (m)Ka-am-bu-zi-ia mari ši-it lib-bi-[ia] ù a]-na nap-ḫar um-ma-ni-ia (28) da-am-ki-iš ik-ru-ub-ma i-na ša-lim-tim ma-ḫar-ša ʔa-bi-iš ni-

his exalted godhead. All the kings dwelling in palaces, (29) of all the quarters of the earth, from the Upper to the Lower sea dwelling . . . all the kings of the West-land dwelling in tents (30) brought me their heavy tribute, and in Babylon kissed my feet. From . . . to Asshur and Susa, (31) Agade, Eshnunak, Zamban, Meturnu, Deri, with the territory of the land of Gutium, the cities on the other side of the Tigris, whose sites were of ancient foundation—(32) the gods, who dwelt in them, I brought them back to their places, and caused them to dwell in a habitation for all time. All their inhabitants I collected and restored them to their dwelling places. (33) And the gods of Shumer and Akkad, whom Nabonidus, to the anger of the lord of the gods, had brought into Babylon, by command of Marduk, the great lord, (34) I caused them peacefully to take up their dwelling in habitations that rejoiced the heart. May all the gods, whom I brought into their cities, (35) pray daily before Bel and Nabu for long life for me, and may they speak a gracious word for me and say to Marduk, my lord, “May Cyrus, the king who worships thee, and Cambyses, his son, (36) their . . . I permitted all to dwell in peace . . .

it-ta-['-id i-lu-ti-šu] šir-ti nap-ḥar šarri a-ši-ib parakke (29) ša ka-li-iš kib-ra-a-ta iš-tu tam-tim e-li-tim a-di tam-tim šap-li-tim a-ši-ib kul-[-. . .] šarrani matī A-mur-ri-i a-ši-ib kuš-ta-ri ka-li-šu-un (30) bi-lat-su-nu ka-bi-it-tim ú-bi-lu-nim-ma ki-ir-ba Babilī ú-na-aš-ši-ku še-pu-ú-a iš-tu [-. . .] a-di alu Aššur(ki) ù Sušan(ki) (31) A-ga-de(ki) mātu Eš-nu-nak (alu) Za-am-ba-an (alu) Me-túr-nu, Deri(ki) a-di pa-aṭ māt Ku-ti-i ma-ḥa-za [šá e-bir]-ti (nāru) Diklat šá iš-tu ap-na-ma na-du-ú šú-bat-su-un (32) ilāni a-ši-ib lib-bi-šu-nu a-na aš-ri-šu-nu ú-tir-ma ú-šar-ma-a šú-bat da-er-a-ta kul-lat niše-šu-nu ú-pa-aḥ-ḫi-ra-am-ma ú-te-ir da-ád-mi-šu-un (33) ù ilāni māt Sú-me-ri ù Akkadī(ki) šá (m, ilu) Nabu-na'id a-na ug-ga-tim bel ilāni ú-še-ri-bi a-na ki-rib Babilī i-na ki-bi-ti (ilu) Marduk belu rabū i-na šá-li-im-tim (34) i-na maš-ta-ki-šu-nu ú-še-ši-ib šú-ba-at ṭu-ub lib-bi kul-la-ta ilāni ša ú-še-ri-bi a-na ki-ir-bi ma-ḥa-zi-šu-un (35) ú-mi-ša-am ma-ḥar (ilu) Bel ù (ilu) Nabu ša a-ra-ku ume-ia li-ta-mu-ú lit-taš-ka-ru a-ma-a-ta du-un-ki-ia ù a-na (ilu) Marduk beli-ia li-ik-bu-ú ša (m) Ku-ra-aš šarri pa-li-ḫi-ka u (m) Ka-am-bu-zi-ia mari-šu (36) da . . . ib-šú-nu lu-ú . . . ka-li-ši-na šú-ub-ti ni-iḫ-tim

. birds and doves (?)

.
his . . . I made strong . . .

.
[The remainder of the tablet affords only about nine
separated words which yield no connected meaning.]

ú-še-ši-ib [. . .] paspase u 𐎶𐎵.𐎶𐎶.𐎶𐎶 (38) [. . . ad-m]a-na-šu
du-un-nu-nim aš-te'-e-ma

LEGAL TEXTS